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IRAN FIRES MISSILES DESPITE TRUCE

■ TEHRAN BLOCKS OIL TANKERS
OVER 'CEASEFIRE BREACH'

■ UAE PREVAILED IN WAR IT
SOUGHT TO AVOID: GARGASH

■ 254 KILLED IN ISRAEL'S
FIERCEST STRIKES ON LEBANON

DUBAI

BY STEPHEN N. R.
Senior Associate Editor

Gulf states continued to come under attack from Iran despite a ceasefire agreement, underscoring the fragility of the truce and raising fresh doubts after reports that the 10-point plan published by Tehran differs from the version under discussion with Washington.

The UAE said it had faced 17 ballistic missiles and 35 drones since the ceasefire took effect, with air defences intercepting the incoming threats.

Qatar reported it had intercepted seven ballistic missiles and multiple drones, while Kuwait said its oil facilities, power stations and desalination plants suffered "severe material damage" following Iranian strikes.

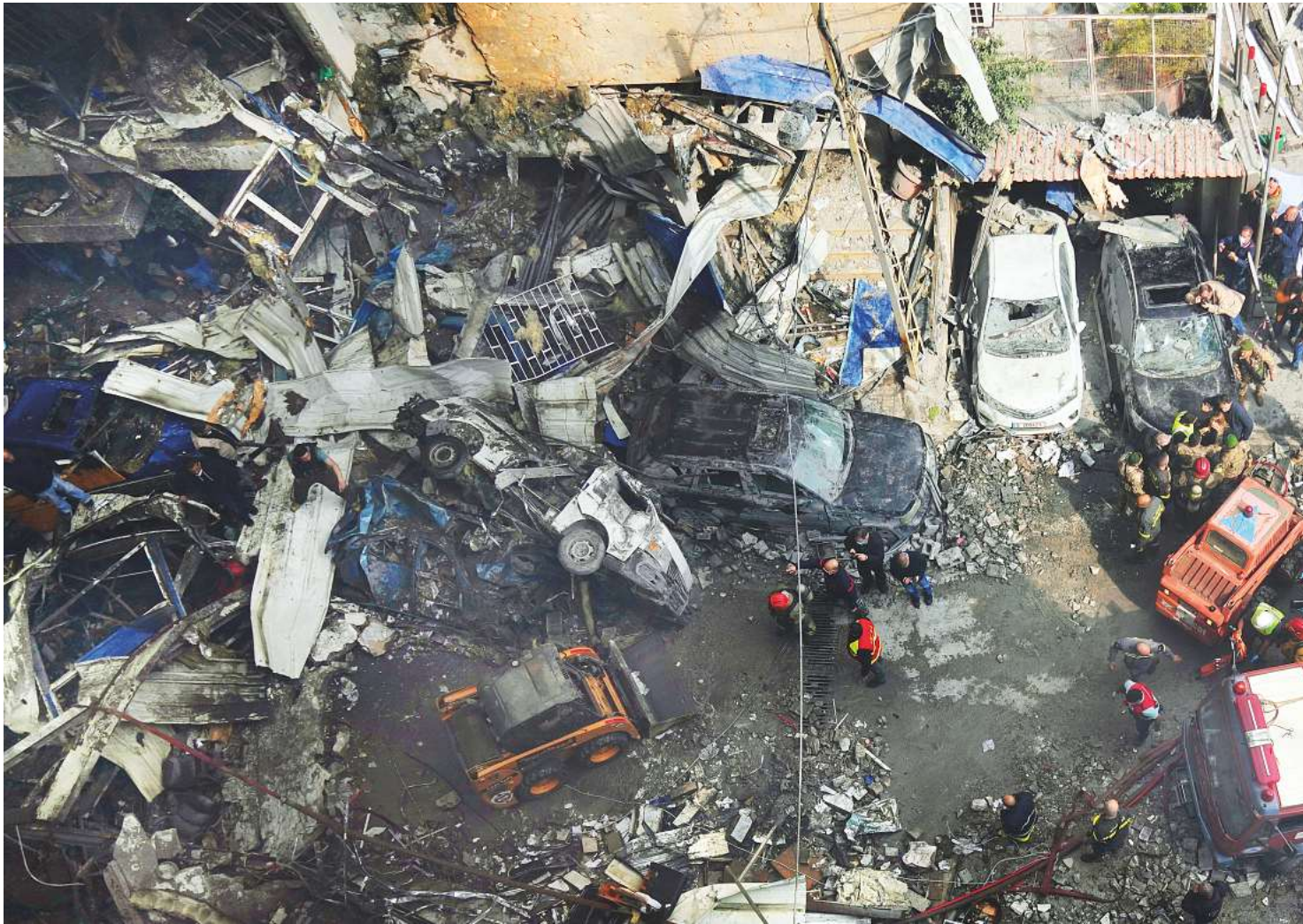
Saudi Arabia too reported a drone attack targeting its vital east-west pipeline, a key artery for global energy supplies.

The attacks highlight how tensions remain high even as Washington and Tehran move towards diplomacy. Pakistani Prime Minister Shehbaz Sharif, whose country helped mediate the ceasefire, warned that reported violations across the conflict zone risk undermining the peace process and urged all sides to exercise restraint. He said Pakistan was ready to host US and Iranian officials for talks tomorrow.

'Heroic national defence'

In the UAE, Diplomatic Adviser Dr Anwar Gargash said the country had prevailed in a war it sought to avoid, crediting a "heroic national defence" for protecting sovereignty and key infrastructure.

He said the UAE would move forward with greater resilience and a stronger ability to navigate a complex regional landscape.



AFP

■ First responders work at the site of an Israeli airstrike that struck an apartment building in Beirut, Lebanon, yesterday.

Iran signalled it would retain control over the Strait of Hormuz, saying tankers had been halted due to Israel's "ceasefire breach", even as the Revolutionary Guards warned their "finger is on the trigger" and naval forces told ships to seek permission to transit.

Oil prices, which had dropped sharply below \$100 a barrel after the ceasefire, remained volatile amid renewed tensions.

After threatening to bring Iran "back to the Stone Age," US President Donald Trump pivoted to promoting what he

described as a potential "Golden Age" for the region following the ceasefire and planned negotiations.

He said the United States would ensure the reopening and stability of the Strait of Hormuz, signalling its central role in any deal.

'Big money' opportunities

Trump also framed the agreement in economic terms, expressing confidence that reconstruction and stability could unlock "big money" opportunities across the region.

The ceasefire, he said, would

pave the way for negotiations based on a 10-point proposal submitted by Iran.

However, US officials later indicated that the framework Washington was working with differed from the version publicly released by Tehran, highlighting continuing gaps between the two sides.

Despite the diplomatic push, violence has continued elsewhere. Israel carried out one of its most intense waves of strikes on Lebanon, launching around 100 air strikes in just 10 minutes across multiple locations, including Beirut. Lebanese au-

thorities said 254 people were killed and 1,165 wounded, as panic spread through the capital.

The escalation underlines how the ceasefire does not extend to all fronts of the conflict. Israel has made clear that Lebanon, where it is targeting the Iran-backed group Hezbollah, is not covered by the truce.

For now, both Washington and Tehran have claimed victory, but the continued attacks on Gulf states and competing narratives point to a ceasefire that remains deeply fragile.

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Markets rally as ceasefire sends oil plunging

Global stocks surge and dollar weakens as US-Iran truce eases energy fears

DUBAI

BY JUSTIN VARGHESE
Your Money Editor

Global markets rallied sharply yesterday after the United States and Iran agreed to a temporary ceasefire, easing fears of further disruption to energy supplies and raising prospects of the Strait of Hormuz reopening.

Oil prices plunged more than 15 per cent, with benchmark crude falling to just above \$90 a barrel. The decline follows weeks of conflict that had pushed prices sharply higher and strained the global economy.

"A wave of relief has hit financial markets," said Susanah Streeter, chief investment



AFP

■ Stock market numbers are displayed on the floor of the New York Stock Exchange during morning trading yesterday.

strategist, Wealth Club, pointing to reduced fears of escalation. Equity markets surged worldwide. Wall Street's three main indexes opened more than 2 per cent higher. European markets

gained between 2 per cent and 5 per cent, while Japan's Nikkei jumped 5.4 per cent. Chinese indexes rose about 3 per cent.

The US dollar weakened against the euro, yen and pound

as investors shifted back to risk assets. Still, analysts warned the rebound may prove fragile. "Markets are not pricing in peace but a window for negotiation," said John Plassard of Cite Gestion, noting uncertainty over whether talks will lead to a lasting deal.

Shipping data showed limited movement through the Strait of Hormuz, with only a few vessels passing. Around 800 ships remain affected, according to industry estimates, while some operators said it was too early to resume normal routes.

The International Air Transport Association said jet fuel supply chains may take months to stabilise. Energy stocks fell as oil retreated, while airlines, banks and mining firms led gains. "I don't think we're going to quickly go back to pre-war levels," said Kathleen Brooks, research director at XTB traders, citing ongoing risks to Gulf infrastructure.

SEE ALSO P8

Iran's new 10-point plan: Will it help end the war?

Hormuz reopening and sanctions relief at heart of proposal

DUBAI

BY ALEX ABRAHAM
Senior Associate Editor

Iran put forward a sweeping 10-point plan to secure an end to its war with the United States and Israel, centring on a permanent halt to hostilities, the reopening of the Strait of Hormuz and the lifting of sanctions, as both sides agreed to a fragile two-week ceasefire to allow negotiations.

The proposal, described by US President Donald Trump as "workable", forms the basis of expected talks in the coming days.

Following is Iran's 10-point plan for a conditional two-

week ceasefire:

■ Complete cessation of the war on Iraq, Lebanon, and Yemen

■ Complete and permanent cessation of the war on Iran with no time limit

■ Ending all conflicts in the region in their entirety

■ Reopening the Strait of Hormuz

■ Establishing a protocol to ensure freedom and security of navigation

■ Full payment of compensation for reconstruction costs to Iran

■ Full commitment to lifting sanctions on Iran

■ Release of Iranian funds and frozen assets held by the United States

■ Iran commits to not seeking nuclear weapons

■ Immediate ceasefire across all fronts upon approval